MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026- Fourth Semester - **Q.P. Code 25901530**

Skill Enhancement Course (**SEC) - MG4SECSWK200 - Communication for Development**

Part A Short Answer) Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. Outline the structure of an effective persuasive narrative**. [K] / [CO2 -2 marks**
   - **Introduction** that presents the issue and captures audience attention.
   - **Body and conclusion** that provide arguments, evidence, and a strong call to action.

2. Explain how Behaviour Change Communication differs from information dissemination. **- [K] / [CO1- 2 marks**
   - **Behaviour Change Communication** focuses on influencing attitudes and encouraging positive behavioural change.
   - **Information dissemination** mainly provides facts or knowledge without necessarily aiming to change behaviour.

3. Describe how visuals enhance audience understanding**.- [K] / [CO4]- 2 marks**
   - **Visuals simplify complex information** and make messages easier to understand.
   - **Images, charts, and graphics increase attention and memory retention.**

4. Describe the role of visuals in literacy-sensitive campaigns- **[K] / [CO1]- 2 marks**
   - **Pictures and symbols communicate messages** even to people with low literacy levels.
   - **Visual storytelling helps explain ideas clearly** without relying heavily on written text.

5. Describe the major recommendations of the MacBride Commission report. - **[U] / [CO6]- 2 marks**
   - It emphasized the need for a New World Information and Communication Order for balanced global communication.
   - It recommended **equal access to information and stronger communication systems in developing countries**.

6. State the main contribution of Nora C. Quebral to the field of development communication**.- [K] / [CO6]- 2 marks**
   - She **coined and defined the concept of Development Communication** as a field of study.
   - She emphasized **communication as a tool for social and economic development**.

7. List the major stages in designing a communication campaign.- **[K] / [CO3- 2 marks**
   - **Situation analysis and audience research** to understand the problem and target group.
   - **Planning, implementation, and evaluation** of the communication strategy.

Part B Short Essay Answer any 4 questions Each question carries 5 marks

8. Apply drama techniques to design an anti-drug campaign **[A] / [CO2, CO4]- 5 marks**

a) **Use street theatre or role-play** to show the harmful effects of drug abuse on individuals and families.
b) **Create strong characters and conflict** that demonstrate the dangers of addiction and making healthy choices.
c) **Include emotional storytelling** to help the audience connect with the victims of drug abuse.
d) **Encourage audience participation** through interactive drama or discussion after the performance.
e) **End with a clear message and solution**, such as seeking help, counselling, or community support.

9. Apply storytelling techniques to create a narrative for a child protection campaign . **- A] / [CO2 - 5 marks**
   - **Introduce a relatable child character** facing a problem such as neglect or abuse.
   - **Present the conflict or challenge** that highlights the importance of child safety.
   - **Use emotional and engaging storytelling** to create empathy among the audience.
   - **Show intervention by responsible adults or community members** who protect the child.
   - **Conclude with a positive message** encouraging society to report abuse and protect children.

10. Discuss challenges in maintaining authenticity online. [**A] / [CO5**] - **5 marks**
   - **Spread of misinformation and fake news** makes it difficult to verify accurate information.
   - **Pressure to create ideal or exaggerated online identities** reduces authenticity.
   - **Manipulated images and edited content** may misrepresent reality.
   - **Influence of social media algorithms** that promote sensational or trending content.
   - **Difficulty in verifying sources and credibility** of online information.

11. Analyze a social media campaign that successfully influenced public behavior.- **[An] / [CO3 -5 marks**]

Example: The **#IceBucketChallenge** campaign.

1. It **raised awareness about** Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis (ALS).
2. **Viral participation** encouraged millions of people to upload videos and challenge others.
3. **Celebrity involvement** increased global attention and engagement.
4. The campaign **successfully raised significant funds for medical research**.
5. It showed how **social media can motivate collective action and behaviour change**.

12. Analyze how body language affects credibility. . **[An] / [CO4] -5 marks**

1. **Confident posture and steady eye contact** increase trust and authority.
2. **Consistent facial expressions** support the spoken message and show sincerity.
3. **Open gestures and relaxed posture** create a positive impression.
4. **Nervous movements or lack of eye contact** may reduce credibility.
5. **Alignment between verbal and non-verbal communication** strengthens the speaker's reliability.

13. Analyze the effectiveness of traditional media compared to digital media in rural development -[An] / [CO1] -**5 marks**

- T**raditional media (radio, folk media, street theatre)** are accessible to rural populations with limited internet access.
- **Digital media (social media, websites, mobile apps)** allow faster communication and wider reach.
- Traditional media **build stronger cultural connection and trust** in rural communities.
- Digital media **enable interactive communication and quick feedback**.
- **Combining both media types** often produces the most effective rural development communication.

14. Apply visual hierarchy principles in designing a health awareness poster. **[A] / [CO1-5 marks**

a) **Place the most important message or headline at the top** to capture attention.
b) **Use larger fonts and bold colors** for key information such as health warnings.
c) **Arrange content in a clear order** so the audience reads information step by step.
d) **Use images or icons** to highlight important health messages.
e) **Maintain balance and spacing** to make the poster clear, attractive, and easy to read.

Part C Essay Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 10 marks

15. Analyze how community participation in the strategy phase can change the outcomes of a project- **An] / [CO6]**

a) **Identifies real community needs** and ensures the project addresses local problems.
b) **Encourages community ownership**, increasing commitment to the project.
c) **Improves decision-making** by including local knowledge and experiences.
d) **Builds trust and cooperation** between project organizers and community members.
e) **Enhances sustainability**, as people are more likely to maintain projects they helped design.
f) **Reduces resistance to change** because the community is involved in planning.
g) **Promotes empowerment**, allowing community members to participate in development activities.
h) **Improves transparency and accountability** in project implementation.
i) **Encourages creative local solutions** to development problems.
j) **Leads to more effective and successful project outcomes**.

16. Explain the communication process with a neat diagram and examples [**E] / [CO5**] -**10 marks**

Communication Process- Communication is the process of sending and receiving messages between a sender and a receiver to achieve mutual understanding.

Diagram of Communication Process

Sender → Encoding → Message → Channel → Receiver → Decoding → Feedback → Noise

Important Points

a) **Sender** – the person who initiates the message.
b) **Encoding** – converting ideas into words, symbols, or gestures.
c) **Message** – the information or idea being communicated.
d) **Channel** – the medium used (speech, phone, radio, social media).
e) **Receiver** – the person who receives the message.
f) **Decoding** – interpreting the meaning of the message.
g) **Feedback** – response from the receiver confirming understanding.
h) **Noise** – barriers that distort communication (language problems, distractions).
i) **Example:** A health worker explaining vaccination benefits to villagers.
j) **Effective communication occurs when the receiver clearly understands the message.**

17. Evaluate how communication skills determine the impact of policy writing outputs. [**E] / [CO3, CO5**]- **10 marks**

a) **Clear language** helps readers easily understand policy recommendations.
b) **Logical structure and organization** improve readability and comprehension.
c) **Accurate data presentation** increases credibility and trust.
d) **Persuasive writing techniques** help influence decision-makers and stakeholders.
e) **Concise and focused content** avoids confusion and improves effectiveness.
f) **Use of visuals such as charts and graphs** helps explain complex data.
g) **Appropriate tone and professionalism** strengthen the authority of the document.
h) **Audience-focused writing** ensures the policy addresses stakeholder needs.
i) **Strong conclusions and recommendations** guide policymakers toward action.
j) **Effective communication skills ultimately increase the chances of policy adoption and implementation**

18. Evaluate ethical dilemmas in television and radio reporting. **[E] / [CO5]- 10 marks**

a) **Balancing truth and sensationalism** while reporting news.
b) **Protecting privacy** of victims and vulnerable individuals.
c) **Avoiding biased or misleading information** in reporting.
d) **Ensuring accuracy and fact-checking** before broadcasting.
e) **Managing conflicts of interest** between journalists and organizations.
f) **Responsible coverage of violence and disasters** without causing panic.
g) **Respecting cultural and social sensitivities** in media content.
h) **Avoiding manipulation or editing that distorts reality.**
i) **Maintaining independence from political or corporate pressure.**

j) **Following professional media ethics guidelines** set by organizations like the Press Council of India.